

Me: “Gee, sounds like a long time.”

Him: “The five years are going to go by whether I am learning a new language or not.”

That insight has stayed with me ever since. Oliver Burkeman observes: “The average human lifespan is absurdly, insultingly brief. Assuming you live to be eighty, you have just over four thousand weeks.”¹¹³

Everybody gets 24 hours a day. The clock is ticking, get busy using your 4,000 weeks in a way that you won’t regret in week 3,999.



We have defined what investing is, considered thinking in terms of probabilities, reviewed some bad ideas, and looked at ways to avoid them. Now let’s look at some good ideas that will help how you think about money.

¹⁰⁹ Eddy Elfenbein, twitter.com/EddyElfenbein/status/1788246336430653843 (5:35 pm May 8, 2024).

¹¹⁰ William Shakespeare, *As You Like It*. “All the world’s a stage, And all the men and women merely players; They have their exits and their entrances; And one man in his time plays many parts.” (c.1599).

¹¹¹ As inflation was spiking in 2022, I tried to assess its causes. My list included at #5, “Consumers (overspent without regard to cost).” See: Barry Ritholtz, “Who Is to Blame for Inflation, 1–15,” *The Big Picture* (June 28, 2022).

¹¹² Carl Gustav Jacob Jacobi, “Invert, always invert” (German original: “*man muss immer umkehren*”). See: Hugh Chisholm, *Encyclopaedia Britannica Eleventh Edition* (Cambridge University Press, 1911, Vol. 15, p. 117).

¹¹³ Oliver Burkeman, *Four Thousand Weeks: Time Management for Mortals* (Farrar, Straus and Giroux, 2021).